ST MARY'S DSG, KLOOF

GRADE 10 Term 2 2026

ENGLISH HOME LANGUAGE

Learning Outcome 3: Writing and Presenting

ARGUMENTATIVE ESSAY

ASSESSORS: CLASS TEACHERS **TOTAL: 50**

You are required to **read** and **research extensively** around your chosen subject and then you will write an argumentative essay of 500 - 550 words, in which you analyse the chosen issue.

Research is vital in order to ensure a **persuasive** and **well-reasoned** essay and a **rational** conclusion.

Your point of view must be clear from your thesis statement in your introduction. Your research must support your point of view.

INSTRUCTIONS:

1. Read the given texts as stimulus for the topic below.
2. It is in your own interest to write legibly and to present your work neatly.
3. Do not write in pencil. It will not be marked.
4. A draft is a full essay – a working document – and not a sketch or plan.
5. Your final essay must show that **editing** and **revising** has taken place, and research has been well integrated into your writing.
6. Your draft must be submitted with your essay. (You will print it out)
7. Process:

    - Thur 28 May: Get topics and be assigned a personal Google Doc (ALL work must be done in this document). Do research and planning
    - Fri 29 May: Type 1st draft
    - Mon 1 June: AI feedback and editing
    - Thur 4 June: Use the given prompt for AI feedback & edit your draft
    - **FRIDAY 5 JUNE (CYCLE TEST): Handwritten FINAL essay**
    - **You will be allowed to bring in your 1 page (2nd) planning sheet (handwritten) and your assigned document with your research, typed 1st**
      -Handwritten final essay

-First draft (typed)

-Copy of AI suggestions/feedback (typed)

TEXT 1:

To Read or Not To Read

If you were ever a teenager you'll remember those days – stuck in a stuffy classroom with a fly buzzing against the window, listening to the other students stumble their way through the read-Shakespeare-aloud-lesson (I don't know why it has to be hot,or there has to be a fly, it's just a law of the universe). If you have a teenager today, you'll know that this fine tradition has continued unchanged, or maybe you don't – having been told "nothing" happened at school.

We all know the most common association and use of Shakespeare is as a cure for the most stubborn insomnia. And yes, any students reading this, we know that when you rest your head in your hand with your eyes shielded, you're not staring down at the book with intense concentration. We're just waiting to see if you fall deeply enough asleep that your head slips off your hand. It's the little things in life…

Something else that remains a comforting and extremely annoyingly constant in the face of unsettling and unprecedented times is the ritual question of, "Why do we have to read this?" (Oh bless your heart, we all know you're not going to actually READ it) Or to put it into the words of one of my most, er, "street-smart" kids:

"Agh ma'am," tilts his chair back, "agh ma'am". (You know it's serious when you get the double Agh ma'am.) "Why do I need to know to know this?"
"Well, that's actually a good question. You see, it's really import–"
"Ma'am. When I'm president I don't need to know how to read Shakespeare."

This was the only time a student has stumped me on the "But why do we need to learn this?" Well played kid, well played.

As an English teacher who has a borderline unhealthy love of Shakespeare it kills me to see what we as an education system have done to these plays. These plays were never meant to be read! And most certainly not by tired, bored teenagers! Imagine trying to read someone the dialogue of "Die Hard" or "The Avengers: Infinity War", with each fight scene simply written as "they fight", and convince them that, no, these are really awesome and exciting masterpieces! That's what we've done to Shakespeare. We've taken something dynamic, entertaining, dramatic, and reduced it to a monotone reading, or more accurately, stumbling. Education is ruining our learning when it comes to understanding Shakespeare; our education system tells us that we need to know Shakespeare because it is "classic literature" and "high-brow entertainment for the ages". But have you read those plays? Like really read them? They are filthy; they are violent; and if performed incorrectly, the cannon fire will set the theatre roof on fire and burn it to the ground. (No. Seriously. 1613. Henry VIII. The cannon malfunctioned.) While Shakespeare did write for royalty, his plays were really the mass media entertainment of the day. And boy, did he include some rough humour for the peasants. To quote from Titus Andronicus, (Act 4, Scene ii):
Chiron: "Thou hast undone our mother."
Aaron: "Villain, I have done thy mother."

Yes. That means exactly what you think it means; and you can't get cross with me for writing something so vulgar in my blog because I'm quoting Shakespeare! Pro tip: if your teenager complains that they just can't read Shakespeare because it's so difficult and they just can't understand it, tell them that it's a good thing they don't read (insert particular scene here) because it's way too dirty and inappropriate for them. I guarantee you, within three minutes

you'll hear a gasp and embarrassed tittering. I've done this in my classroom every year for more than a decade. Works every time.

Then there's the follow up. "Why do I have to read this? It's so unrelatable!" Well, yes, on one hand you'll probably never have to deal with seeing the ghost of your father who claims to have been murdered by your uncle slash stepdad and demands you kill him, all while having to deal with your girlfriend and your friends spying on you, getting captured by pirates and then jumping into the grave of your now ex-girlfriend to fight with her brother over her corpse. (See, if you read "Hamlet" properly there's more to it than just Hamlet mumbling to himself pitifully for five acts).

But I'm sure that many teenagers have had conflicts with parents, especially stepparents trying to take over a parental role. Nearly everyone has had to deal with friends who betray them (hopefully you don't react by having them executed!) Who hasn't been deeply disappointed by a lover who had the opportunity to do the difficult thing and stand up for you, but didn't? What about teenagers who have to try hide their new boyfriend or girlfriend because their parents won't approve? Nowadays it is likely to be because of unsuitable age, hair, job, or attitude more than because they come from a family your family has been feuding with for the last century. Or if you haven't had to hide your unsuitable lover, you've been the friend who's had to watch in frustration as your buddy changes overnight because of "true love". Apart from being both relatable and frustrating, "Romeo and Juliet" has an important lesson for us all. Had Romeo sat down and cried over Juliet's "body" for a few hours, neither of them would have died. So before you make any major decisions, sit down and have a good cry! Who hasn't had to deal with peer pressure? Hopefully not your wife trying to convince you to kill your friend and mentor the king, but still. Or that one "caring friend" who shows you what someone else is "really like" by telling half truths and showing you out of context screenshots (looking at you Iago).

The settings and situations might be foreign, but the underlying human condition remains the same. We might never run off into an enchanted forest at night in pursuit of a glimpse of an unrequited lover or smother our spouse to death with a pillow (hopefully). But we've all either been in that position, or know someone who's been in the position of refusing to accept you've been dumped or being insecure and trusting the wrong person.

We want to teach students to be critical thinkers, to analyze situations and think outside the box. Shakespeare offers us the perfect solution to that! What better way to encourage independent thinking than discussing whether Macbeth or Lady Macbeth was more to blame? Was Hamlet justified in his anger towards Ophelia knowing what her home life was like? Shakespeare forces us to face some really uncomfortable situations; he makes us look at how we can have empathy for a murderer or feel pity for a woman who claimed she would (hypothetically) gruesomely murder her baby if she needed to. And he never misses an opportunity to add a sword fight or a dirty joke.

At the end of the day, that's what literature is about. It's about seeing the world through new eyes; finding ourselves mirrored in other characters, even if we don't want to acknowledge it; watching the horrible consequences of actions inevitably unfold; seeing the happiness of true love; and acknowledging that "Yo mama" jokes will always be funny. To quote John Keating from "The Dead Poets' Society":

"We read and write poetry because we are members of the human race. And the human race is filled with passion. And medicine, law, business, engineering, these are noble pursuits and necessary to sustain life. But poetry, beauty, romance, love, these are what we stay alive for."

And that is the answer to why we have to read this.

https://mommysoffhermeds.home.blog/2023/02/15/to-read-or-not-to-read/

TEXT 2

Interrogating the Shakespeare System

I want to talk about Shakespeare. Not Shakespeare the playwright or Shakespeare the poet, but, rather, Shakespeare the system—and what it means for all of us artists, educators, and administrators to be upholding that system. For clarification, the Shakespeare system is not simply Shakespeare's written work, but the complex and oppressive role his work, legacy, and positionality hold in our contemporary society.

Feeling defensive yet? After all, the education system in the United States has trained all of us to believe Shakespeare is the best. Why else would he be the only playwright required in the American Common Core, our academic standards for education? Why else would he be the most produced playwright in the United States? Why else would he be the way children are introduced to theatre? It is that very placement of Shakespeare as the pinnacle of theatrical achievement that I suggest we interrogate. It is time to examine the factors that have led us to assume there is a "best" and that it is him. Are all of his plays good? What exactly is it that makes him superior?

Promoting Shakespeare as the "best" writer of all time is a dangerous and white supremacist viewpoint. Until the Shakespeare field as a whole learns how to examine that, theatres that produce his work cannot be welcoming spaces for people whose ancestors were beaten and forced to give up their own languages and learn Shakespeare's. As a Mohegan theatremaker, it is my duty to make clear that the immense amount of space his work currently takes up is an ongoing tool of colonization, just as his work has been used historically as a weapon to remove other people's cultures and teach them that one British playwright is superior to all other writers. To be clear: I'm not talking about scarcity—there is always room for more plays and more artists. But Shakespeare has not been positioned amongst us. He has been positioned above us, and that is something entirely different.

I'm not saying Shakespeare's plays don't have merits, but they are finite and do not represent all of us. No one should be forced to see themselves through his work. He is one voice from one time period, and his existence should not render anyone else's voice, language, or culture as lesser than. It is likely there are many other playwrights who, given the same positionality, would have been equally prolific. The perpetuation of "the Great Man Theory"—that there is one example of what is best and deserving—only serves the United States' system of capitalism and oppression.

https://howlround.com/interrogating-shakespeare-system

TEXT 3



TEXT 4

ORIGINAL	ADAPTATION	
The Taming of the Shrew The Taming of the Shrew reveals a plot by suitors to marry the younger sister, Bianca, but only once the older and more willful sister Katherine is married first. They succeed in finding her a suitor, Petruchio, and winning the younger sister's affections behind her father's back.	**10 Things I hate about You** Kat Stratford is beautiful, smart and quite abrasive to most of her fellow teens, meaning that she doesn't attract many boys. Unfortunately for her younger sister, Bianca, house rules say that she can't date until Kat has a boyfriend, so strings are pulled to set the dour damsel up for a romance. Soon Kat crosses paths with handsome new arrival Patrick Verona. Kat may let her guard down enough to fall for the effortlessly charming Patrick.	
Hamlet Hamlet's father, the King of Denmark, is murdered by his uncle, Claudius, who then marries Hamlet's mother and becomes king. Hamlet's father's ghost appears to him, revealing Claudius as the murderer and urging him to avenge his death. He returns to avenge his father with the help of his friends, Rosenkrantz and Guildenstern.	**The Lion King** Follows the adventures of the young lion Simba, the heir of the King, his father, Mufasa. Simba's wicked uncle, Scar, plots to usurp Mufasa's throne by luring father and son into a stampede, but Simba escapes, and only Mufasa is killed. After seeing a vision of his dead father, Simba returns as an adult to take back his homeland from Scar with the help of his friends Timon and Pumbaa.	
King Lear King Lear divides his kingdom among the two daughters who flatter him and banishes the third one who loves him. His eldest daughters both then reject him at their homes, so Lear goes mad and wanders through a storm.	**Empire** The Lyons, a wealthy family fighting for control of Empire Entertainment, a production company founded by the ailing family patriarch, hip hop mogul Luscious Lyon. Even containing a direct reference to the Shakespearean drama during the show's pilot episode, both Empire and King Lear follow three siblings vying for control of their dying father's kingdom—in the case of King Lear, the literal kingdom of Britain, and in Empire, the powerhouse media company founded by Lyon.	
Julis Caesar Jealous conspirators convince Caesar's friend Brutus to join their assassination plot against Caesar. To stop Caesar from gaining too much power, Brutus and the conspirators kill him on the Ides of March. Mark Antony drives the conspirators out of Rome and fights them in a battle. **Macbeth** A Scottish general, Macbeth, who, driven by ambition and prophecies from witches, murders King Duncan to seize the throne. This act leads to a cycle of violence, guilt, and paranoia, ultimately resulting in his downfall.	**Mean Girls** "Mean Girls" shares thematic and character parallels with Shakespeare's plays, particularly "Julius Caesar" and "Macbeth." Some have suggested that Cady Heron, the outsider, could be seen as a modern-day Brutus, manipulated into betraying the power structure (Regina George). Gretchen Wieners, Regina's right-hand woman, might also be interpreted as a Brutus figure, vying for power within Regina's "Caesar-like" leadership. Additionally, some have drawn parallels between Cady's plot against the "Queen" (which triggers her transformation from respected friend, to power hungry high school dictator) with that of Macbeth's descent into tyranny.	

TOPIC

Is Shakespeare still relevant to our contemporary society? Argue whether you believe Shakespeare still holds relevance today, and whether or not his works should be taught in schools.

How to apply in-text referencing conventions

In-text referencing includes the acknowledgement of direct quotations AND ideas, concepts or theories that are gathered from your reading and used in your final writing. Even when such ideas, concepts and theories are expressed in your own words, you need to acknowledge that they originate from elsewhere. This is how we do so: *Cite the name of the author/authoring body and the date created or last revised:*

> Tim Burton's films often reflect an outsider character; a character that finds it difficult to fit in with conventional society or who sees himself as not fitting in. It is argued that such characters are very often reflections of Burton himself (Selby, 2012) because Burton sees himself as an outsider. Selby argues that "Burton's own outsider status enables a unique relation to other outsider characters" (Selby, 2012).

THEN, in your bibliography at the end, you will have the full reference:

Selby, J, 27 November 2012, *Empathising With The Outcast*, accessed 28 April 2014, http://burton.brendankredell.com/2012/11/empathising-with-the-outcast/ If there is no Author or article title, you use the name of the web page and the date of that page.

BIBLIOGRAPHIES...USING THE HARVARD CONVENTION

A bibliography is a list of all the resources you have used in writing your assignment.
Bibliographical references need to be cited in two places:

1. Where a document is referred to in the assignment
2. In a list at the end of your assignment, arranged alphabetically by author then by date.

BOOKS with an author

Author's surname, initials. *(full stop)* Year. *(in brackets) (full stop)* Title of book. *(underlined OR italics) (full stop)* Publisher*, (comma)* Place of publication. *(full stop)*

Eg. Smith, P. (1999). *How to write good assignments.* Penguin Books, Ringwood.

NEWSPAPER ARTICLES

Author's surname, initials (*full stop)* Year. (*in brackets) (full stop)* Title of the article. *(full stop*) Title of the newspaper. *(underlined OR italics) (full stop)* Date of publication*, (comma)* Page number of article. *(full stop)*

Eg. Barry, B. (2004). Irrigated pastures. *The Age.* 28 February, p9.

WORLD WIDE WEB

Author's surname, initials. *(full stop)* Year. *(in brackets) (full stop)* Title *(underlined OR italics)* [Internet]. *[in square brackets] (full stop)* Publisher, *(comma)* Place of publication. (*full stop)* Available from: <URL> [accessed date].

Holland, M. (1996). *Harvard System* [Internet]. Bournemouth University, Poole. Available from: http://www.bournemouth.ac.uk/library/using/harvard_system.html [Accessed 1 November 2004].

RUBRIC

NAME:

Criteria	ARGUMENTATIVE ESSAY			
	Level 7 (80 – 100%)	Level 5-6 (60 – 79%)	Level 3-4 (40 – 59%)	Level 1 – 2 (0 – 39%)
Introduction **/5**	**(4 – 5)** An excellent introduction which is original and expresses the line of argument which the learner intends to take succinctly and convincingly.	**(3 – 3,5)** The learner has provided a clear introduction which signposts his/her viewpoint effectively.	**(2 – 2,5)** The learner alludes to the argument but his/her position is unclear. The learner has not provided an explicit statement to explain his/her viewpoint.	**(0 – 1,5)** Learner makes little or no effort to introduce an argument. The introduction is vague and rambling and the focus of the essay is unclear.
Quality of argument **/ 20**	**Level 7: (16 – 20)** The argument is sophisticated, lucid and thought-provoking. The research is skilfully incorporated to convince the reader of the credibility of the argument and is fully sustained.	**Level 6: (14 – 15,5)** The argument is clear and has substance. There is very little deviation from the line of argument and the research is relevant and substantiates the learner's viewpoint convincingly. **Level 5: (12 – 13)** The argument tends to be adequate or pedestrian. The learner has responded to the question but the line of argument lapses in places and the research needed to be used more successfully to substantiate the learner's viewpoint.	**Level 4: (9 – 11,5)** The line of argument is mediocre and is not sustained. The learner has tried to incorporate appropriate research into his/her argument but this is poorly synthesised. **Level 3: (8 – 8,5)** The argument is superficial and there is little evidence of relevant research to substantiate the argument and convince the reader.	**Level 2 (6 – 7)** The argument is vague. The learner's incorporating of research is inadequate and conveys insufficient understanding of the topic. **Level 1 (0 – 5,5)** Some ideas relating to the topic are evident, but they are almost completely undeveloped. No evidence of research is discernible. The learner's line of argument is fragmented and lacks both clarity and conviction.
Structure **/ 10**	**Level 7 (8 -10)** Crisp, clear structure which enhances the overall argument. The structure allows for an effortless reading, and understanding, of the essay. The cohesion of the essay is excellent.	**Level 5 – 6 (6 -7,5)** The structure is logically developed and the links between paragraphs enhance the overall coherence of the essay.	**Level 3 -4 (4 – 5,5)** The transitions between paragraphs are often awkward. However, there is a sense of overall progression in the structure and there is evidence of cohesion.	**Level 1 -2 (0 -3,5)** The structure is haphazard and the reader has difficulty in following the writer's train of thought. The essay is written in a very loose and random manner.
Appropriateness of register and correct use of language conventions **/ 10**	**Level 7: (8 – 10)** Highly competent use of language conventions and excellent understanding of register displayed.	**Level 6: (7½)** Competent, at times impressive, use of language conventions and appropriate register but this is not always sustained. **Level 5: (6 – 7)** Average response. Pedestrian, but not seriously flawed. Mostly accurate use of language conventions.	**Level 4: (5 – 5 ½)** The candidate displays knowledge of the appropriate conventions, but there are lapses in the correct register as well as errors in the accurate use of language conventions. **Level 3: (4 – 4,5)** The candidate tried to apply conventions, but the product is flawed. The register is either incorrect OR inadequately sustained and there is frequent misuse of correct language conventions.	**Level 2: (3 – 3 ½)** The register is inappropriate and there is very little evidence of language conventions being applied correctly. The incorrect use of language conventions is distracting with numerous flaws in grammar and punctuation. **Level 1: (0 – 2,5)** No evidence of language conventions being applied. Inability to use correct register. Communication marred due to serious flaws in grammar and punctuation.
Bibliography **/ 5**	**(4 – 5)** All sources are acknowledged and properly referenced.	**(3 – 3,5)** All sources have been acknowledged and the referencing to the sources is correct except for one or two instances.	**(2 – 2,5)** Most sources have been acknowledged but the format of the sources in the bibliography is not always correct.	**(0 – 1,5)** No bibliography or bibliography is inaccurately documented.

COMMENT:

Step-by-Step Guide to Creating a Bibliography in Google Docs

1. Open the Citation Tool:
    - Open your document in Google Docs.
    - Go to Tools > Citations.
    - A sidebar will appear on the right.
2. Select Your Format:
    - In the sidebar, select your preferred format from the dropdown menu: MLA (8th ed.), **APA (7th ed.)**, or Chicago Author-Date (17th ed.).
3. Add Citation Sources:
    - Click + Add citation source.
    - Select the source type (e.g., Book, Website, Journal Article) and how you accessed it (e.g., Print, Website).
    - Enter the ISBN for books or URL for websites to allow Google to automatically find the information.
    - Click Search to populate the data, then click Continue.
    - Review and edit the details (fields with a blue asterisk are recommended).
    - Click Add citation source.
4. Insert In-Text Citations (Optional):
    - Place your cursor in the document where you want the citation to appear.
    - Hover over the source in the sidebar and click Cite.
5. Insert the Bibliography:
    - Place your cursor at the end of your document (where you want the bibliography/works cited to begin).
    - Click the Insert Bibliography button at the bottom of the Citations sidebar.
    - The tool will automatically create an alphabetized list of your sources in the selected format.

Updating Sources: If you add new sources to the sidebar after inserting the bibliography, you may need to delete the old one and click Insert Bibliography again to update it.

To add **Harvard referencing** in Google Docs, use a dedicated extension like MyBib or Paperpile (via Extensions > Add-ons) because native Google Docs tools only support APA, MLA, and Chicago. MyBib is free, generates accurate Harvard in-text citations and bibliographies, and allows copying formatted citations directly into your document MyBib.

Native Google Docs Citation Tool Method (Alternative):

Select APA (as a proxy, though it is not true Harvard) to at least manage sources.

Step-by-Step Guide to Harvard Referencing in Google Docs:

1. Install a Generator: Go to Extensions > Add-ons > Get add-ons and search for "MyBib" or "Cite This For Me".
2. Activate the Add-on: Open the extension (e.g., MyBib) from the extensions menu.
3. Select Harvard Style: In the add-on sidebar, set your citation style to "Harvard" (select a specific university format if necessary).
4. Add Sources: Search by URL, ISBN, or Title to find your source, then click "Add".
5. Insert Citations: Place your cursor in the document, go back to the sidebar, and click "Cite" next to the source to add in-text citations.
6. Generate Bibliography: Place your cursor at the end of the paper, and click "Download/Insert Bibliography" to generate the full reference list.

ALTERNATIVE: How to Use Harvard in Google Docs

- Manual Method: If doing it manually, Harvard requires in-text parenthetical citations, typically (Author Surname, Year).
- References Page: Compile a list of references alphabetically at the end, formatted as: Author Surname, Initials. (Year) *Title*. Place: Publisher.

Key Aspects of Harvard Formatting:

- **Author-Date System: Uses (Author, Year) in-text.**
- **No Footnotes: The style avoids footnotes, favoring in-text citations.**

WATCH: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=mOr_FfGI9wM